



"CLASSICAL RAJASTHAN TRIP – 14 Nights"

Meal Plan – Half board basis

Day 01

**Arrival Delhi
By International flight**

Arrive at Indira Gandhi International airport in the Evening hrs

Meet, Greet & Welcome at the airport by our office representative & transfer to hotel.

DELHI: New Delhi, the capital and the third largest city of India is a fusion of the ancient and the modern. Standing along the West End of Gangetic Plain, the capital city, Delhi, unwinds a picture rich with culture, architecture and human diversity, deep in history, monuments, museums, galleries, gardens and exotic shows. Comprising of two contrasting yet harmonious parts, the Old Delhi and New Delhi, the city is a travel hub of Northern India.



buildings.

Narrating the city's Mughal past, Old Delhi, takes you through the labyrinthine streets passing through formidable mosques, monuments and forts. You will also discover lively and colorful bazaars that boast to cater all sorts of good and items at mind-blowing prices amidst a barely controlled chaotic ambience. The imperial city of New Delhi displays the finely curved architecture of British Raj. It generates a mesmerizing charm reflecting well-composed and spacious streets under the shade of beautifully lined avenues of trees and tall and imposing government

On arrival Check-In at hotel

Overnight at hotel

Day 02

In Delhi

Breakfast at hotel

Start your tour with visit of **Shahjahanbad (Old Delhi)**

The 300-year-old walled city, built by the Mughal Emperor Shah Jehan in 1648 as his capital. The focus of the city is the magnificent Red Fort and Jama Mosque built of red sandstone. Drive past the Red Fort from where the Prime Minister of India addresses the nation on India's Independence Day.

Enjoy a Cycle rickshaw ride through the busy bazaars of the Chandani Chowk area

Visit Jama Masjid, the most elegant mosque in India that stands high on a hillock. In between and around these two focal points of the 17th century city is a thriving modern city in medieval setting. This area once had a tree-lined central avenue, with a canal dividing the thoroughfare.

Also visit Raj Ghat, Mahatma Gandhi's shrine.

Further proceed to visit New Delhi - the early 20th century British capital, designed by Sir Edward Lutyens and Herbert Baker. Drive past *the President's House, the Rashtrapati Bhavan and the two flanking Secretariat buildings* – the nerve centre of Government activity. Driving down this hill is the India Gate, the great memorial arch built to commemorate the slain heroes of World War -1 and Indo-Afghan war. Around India Gate are palaces of some erstwhile princely states that are now public offices and museums.

Proceed to Gurudwara Bangla Sahib - is one of the most prominent Sikh gurdwaras, or Sikh house of worship, in Delhi, India, and known for its association with the eighth Sikh Guru, Guru Har Krishan, as well as the holy pond inside its complex, known as the "Sarovar." It was first built as a small shrine by Sikh General Sardar Baghel Singh in 1783, on the bungalow donated by king Raja Jai Singh of Amer, who supervised the construction of nine Sikh shrines in Delhi in the same year, during the reign of Mughal Emperor, Shah Alam II.

End your trip with visit to Qutab Minar: Qutab Minar is at 72.5 meters the world's tallest brick minaret. Construction commenced in 1193 under the orders of India's first Muslim ruler Qutab-ud-din Aibak, and the topmost storey of the minaret was completed in 1386 by Firuz Shah Tughluq. The Qutab Minar is notable for being one of the earliest and most prominent examples of Indo-Islamic architecture. It is surrounded by several other ancient and medieval structures and ruins, collectively known as Qutab complex. The complex is listed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site

Return to hotel by evening

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 03**Drive Delhi-Mandawa
(270 kms/6-7 hrs)**

Breakfast at hotel

Check Out from hotel & transfer to Mandawa

Mandawa: A lovely, subdued little market town. Mandawa is an excellent base for exploring the region. It was settled in the 18th century, and fortified by the dominant merchant families.

On arrival check-in at hotel

Afternoon visit Havelis - The popular design was a building, which from the outside was relatively unremarkable, the focus being the one or more internal courtyards. This served the purposes of security and privacy for the women, as well as offering some relief from the fierce heat which grips the area in summer. The plain exteriors also made the houses easily defensible
Evening at leisure

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel**Day 04****Drive Mandawa-Bikaner
(190 kms/4 hrs drive)**

Breakfast at hotel

Check Out from hotel & transfer to Bikaner

Bikaner - Rao Bikaji, a descendant of the founder of Jodhpur, founded this desert town in the north of the state in 1488. Like many others in Rajasthan, the old city is surrounded by high crenellated walls and was once an important staging post on the great caravan trade routes. The city is chiefly interesting for its superb large fort, but is also known for the fine camel's bread here.

On arrival, Check-In at hotel

Afternoon visit **Junagarh Fort:** It is an unassailable fortress, which had never been conquered. Built in 1593 A.D. by Raja Rai Singh, one of the most distinguished generals in the army of Emperor Akbar, the fort is a formidable structure encircled by a moat. The main entrance to the fort is Karan Pol [gate] that is facing east. Next to it is the Suraj Pol meaning the sun gate. In the fort complex are some magnificent palaces like Anup Mahal, Ganga Niwas and Rang Mahal or palace of pleasure. The Har Mandir is the majestic chapel for the royal family for worshipping their gods and goddesses. These palaces, constructed in red sandstone and marble, make a picturesque ensemble of courtyards, balconies, kiosks and windows dotted all over the structure. The premises also house a museum, which has an array of rich collection.



Also enjoy a TUK TUK in the Old Markets of Bikaner town

National Research Center (10 km): Spend some time with the indispensable ship of the desert at the camel research and breeding centres which is only one of its kinds in Asia. The farm extends over 2000 acres of semi-arid land and is managed by the Government of India.

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 05

Drive Bikaner-Jaisalmer (190 kms/4 hrs drive)

Breakfast at hotel

Check Out & drive to Jaisalmer

Jaisalmer: Nothing else in India is remotely similar to Jaisalmer. Here the yellow sandstone fort is an imposing sight, towering magnificently over the city. This desert fortress is straight out of the Tales of the Arabian Nights and you could easily be forgiven for imagining the you'd somehow been transported back to medieval Afghanistan. This magic, incomparably romantic and totally unspoiled city has been dubbed the "Golden City" because of the colour imparted to its stone ramparts by the setting sun. Centuries ago, Jaisalmer's strategic position on the camel train routes between India and central Asia brought it great wealth. The merchants and townspeople built magnificent houses and mansions, all exquisitely carved from wood and from golden-yellow sandstone. Although the Old city was once completely surrounded by an extensive wall, Jaisalmer largely escaped direct conquest by the Muslim rulers of Delhi, it did experience its share of sieges and sacking with the inevitable jauhar being declared in the face of inevitable defeat.

On arrival, check in at hotel

Evening visit cenotaphs of Bara Bagh - which literally means 'Big Garden', is located on the Ramgarh road. It was commissioned by Maharawal Jait Singh in the early 16th century and completed by his son Lunakaran after his death. The site has three different things to watch, a garden, a tank and a dam. In the vicinity itself you will find Govardhan Stambh (pillar). This pillar was constructed to commemorate the construction of the Dam and the tank. In the local dialect the Dam and the tank are known as Jait Bandh and the Jait Sar respectively.



Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 06

In Jaisalmer

Breakfast at hotel

Morning city tour of Jaisalmer includes of Gadi Sagar & Jaisalmer fort:

Gadi Sagar: A man made reservoir built in 1156 AD, is one of the most favourite tourist attraction in Jaisalmer. It was originally constructed by the King Jaisal and later it was reconstructed by Maharaja Garsi Singh in 1367 AD, making a new name 'Lake Garsisar'. During the Rajput clan period, it was the only resource for the drinking water in Jaisalmer. The lake is marvellously placed in a picturesque surroundings and an imposing sandstone entrance known as Tilon-ki-Pol opens to the lake. A grand Krishna temple is also placed at the gate. The banks of the Gadi Sagar enclose superbly maintained gardens, temples and majestically carved Chattris.



Continue to visit the Jaisalmer fort that stands about 100 meters over the city and in fact houses a citadel within its huge ramparts. Walking down the narrow cobbled stone lanes, one can feel the sheer magic of Jaisalmer. Several entrances called Pols, including the Ganesh Pol, Suraj Pol, Bhoota Pol and the Hava Pol guard the Megh Durbar and the Jawahar Mahal which were occupied by the royal family. Also visit the Havelis (mansions of the rich merchants) have beautifully carved facades, jali screens and oriel windows overhanging the streets below. Visit Salim Singh Haveli (17 century) which is especially attractive with peacock brackets. Nathumal Haveli (1885) was built for the prime minister. Patwon Haveli (1805) is a group of five, built for five brothers. Possibly the finest in town. They have fine murals and carved pillars. A profusion of balconies cover the front wall.



Evening excursion to Sand Dunes with Camel ride followed by dinner & cocktail and traditional dance show

The Sam dunes are the most picturesque spot around Jaisalmer, and perhaps the whole of western Rajasthan. Sitting there in the evening with the sun setting, listening to the ballads of the legendary lovers Moomal and Mahendra on the jew's harp or the narh (a traditional musical instrument), you might feel that time has come to a grinding halt. The silken smooth sands of Sam look like a tale out of the Merchant of Venice and camel safaris re much in vogue here. There is a definite aura of romance about it.

Return to hotel for Overnight

Day 07**Drive to Jodhpur
(270 kms/6 hrs drive)**

Breakfast in tents

Check Out & drive to Jodhpur

Jodhpur: At the edge of the Thar Desert, stands the 2nd largest city of Rajasthan – Jodhpur. The city is totally dominated by the massive fort, topping a sheer hill which rises right in the middle of the town. Founded in 1459 by Rao Jodha, a chief of the Rajput clan known as the Rathores. The Rathore kingdom was once known as Marwar, the Land of Death. It's fascinating to wander around the jumble of winding streets in the old city. Eight gates lead out from the walled city. It's one of India's most interesting cities and, yes, it was from here that those baggy-tights horse-riding trousers, Jodhpuries took their name.

Upon arrival, Check-in to the hotel

Afternoon **visit Mehrangarh fort & Jaswant Thada** – an imposing white marble cenotaph built to commemorate the acts of bravery and generosity of the rulers in 19th century



Mehrangarh Fort– founded in 1459 ad by Rao Jodha (after whom the city is named) the fort is intricately adorned with long carved panels and latticed windows of exquisite designs in Red Sandstone.

After visit, walking tour to local Bazaars & Clock tower area

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 08**Drive to Udaipur
(275 kms/5-6 hrs drive)**

Breakfast at hotel

Check Out from hotel & transfer to Udaipur Enroute visiting Ranakpur

Ranakpur the 3 wonderful temples of the Jain sect dating back to the 14th/15th century. The unforgettable main Temple dedicated to Adinatha the first Tirthankar (1439) built in marble took 65 years to complete. It is one of the five holy Jain pilgrimage centers, and has one of the best temple complexes.

Thereafter, continue drive to Udaipur –

UDAIPUR lies in the Girwa valley amidst the Aravali hills of south Rajasthan. It is considered a romantic city - with its lakes, gardens, temples and palaces - an Oasis in the Thar Desert. The old city is a traditionally planned fortified walled city, a maze of narrow winding lanes flanked by houses with doorways decorated with Mewar folk art, windows with stained glass or jali screens, massive havelis with large inner courtyards and shops. The legendary Ranas who ruled traced their ancestry to the Sun Dynasty.

On arrival, Check-In at hotel

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel**Day 09****In Udaipur****Early morning private Yoga session at hotel with a trained yoga professional Guru**

***"Yoga has a complete message for humanity
It has a message for the human body,
It has a message for the human mind,
and it has also a message for the human soul"***

Yoga is an ancient philosophy of life as well as a system of exercises that encourages the union of mind, body, and spirit. In the words of Patanjali, author of the Yoga Sutras, "yoga is the ability to focus the mind on a single point without distraction." Yoga is a physical discipline; it uses the body and breathing to develop self-awareness and mental clarity. There is simply no other discipline quite like yoga because it utilized the body, mind and spirit, all in one practice. Yoga is indeed a spiritual path that is based on ancient sacred philosophy, but one does not need to make an ethical decision when practicing yoga, rather finding your own path is wholly accepted. The holistic benefits of yoga are suitable for the young or old, sick or well, with any religious



background. The secrets of yoga are inwardness, concentration, and purification of mind and body with cleansing thoughts

Later breakfast at hotel

Further visit the City Palace built on the bank of the Pichola Lake, by Maharana Udai Singh in 1570. The impressive complex of several palaces is a blend of Rajput and Mughul influences. Half of it is still occupied by the Royal family, and part converted into a museum. **The Jagdish Temple (1651)** was built by Maharana Jagat Singh. A fine example of the Nagara style of temple architecture. A brass Garuda stands outside and stone elephants flank the entrance steps. Inside is a black stone image of Vishnu as Jagannath, the Lord of the Universe.

Also visit **Sahelion-ki-Bari** an ornamental pleasure garden specially made for the ladies of the palace in the 18th century. It has beautiful fountains, trees and flowers.

Late afternoon, enjoy Boat ride on Lake Pichola - *A manmade lake, Lake Pichola is one of the prime attractions of Udaipur. The lake is known for the palace build amidst the lake. The lake was built by Maharana Udai Singh II. It was made basically for defence purpose. Cradled amongst hills, gardens, havelis, temples and ghats, Lake Pichola is the picturesque spotlight of Udaipur. The lake is about 4 km long and 3 km wide, and not much deep- it often dries up in times of severe summers. The beauty of the lake and its surroundings can only be felt by seeing it, which increases many folds during sunrise and sunset*



Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 10

**Drive Udaipur-Pushkar
(5-6 hrs drive)**

Breakfast at hotel

Check Out from hotel & transfer to Pushkar

Enroute visiting Pushkar: Situated right on the edge of the desert, is this town clinging to the side of a small but beautiful Pushkar Lake, with its many bathing ghats and temples. It's world famous for camel and cattle fair. At this time the town is thronged with tribal people from all over Rajasthan & Pilgrims from all over India. There are many temples, though few are as ancient as you might expect at such a pilgrimage site, since many were destroyed by Aurangzeb and subsequently rebuilt. The most famous is the only temple in India dedicated to Brahma. It's marked by a red spire and over the entrance gateway is the Hans (goose symbol of Brahma).



In the afternoon we organize walking tour of Pushkar town along with visit to Brahma temple.

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 11

Drive Pushkar-Jaipur (3 hrs drive)

Breakfast at hotel

Check out from Pushkar and drive to Jaipur

Jaipur: The capital city of the state of Rajasthan is popularly known as the “Pink City” because of the pink paint applied to the buildings in the old walled city. (In Rajput culture, pink was traditionally a colour associated with hospitality) The city owes its name, its foundation and its careful planning to the great warrior, astronomer Maharaja Jai Singh II (1699-1744). In 1727, with Mughal power on the wane, Jai Singh decided the time was ripe to move down from his somewhat cramped hillside fortress at nearby Amber to the new site. He laid out the city, with its surrounding walls and six rectangular blocks, according to principles of town planning set down in the Shilpa-Shastra, an ancient Hindu treatise on architecture

On arrival, check in at hotel

Evening – Indian Home Visit, Cultural Interaction & Culinary Experience:-

This evening, experience authentic Indian hospitality with an exclusive visit to a local family's home. Upon arrival, you will be warmly welcomed by your hosts for an insightful conversation on Indian lifestyle, family values, and age-old cultural traditions over refreshing drinks. Following the interaction, your host will lead a hands-on cooking demonstration, walking you through the subtle art of Indian spice blending and the preparation of iconic regional delicacies. The evening culminates in a delightful, home-cooked dinner shared with the family, offering a true taste of Indian warmth and culinary tradition.

Return to hotel for Overnight stay

Day 12

In Jaipur

Breakfast at hotel

Morning visit Fort Amber by Elephant/Jeep - **Ascent to the fort on Elephants; Return to base by jeeps.**

Amber Fort 11 kms from Jaipur – marvellous example of Rajput architecture with its terraces and ramparts reflected in the Maota Lake below. The fort interior has various royal halls decorated with intricate ivory work, exquisite wall paintings and tiny mirror chips, which create a tantalizing reflection effect. **Enroute to Fort; Photo stop at Hawa Mahal**



Afternoon city tour of Jaipur includes:



City Palace museum – an imposing blend of traditional Rajasthani and Mughal Art. The museum is resplendent with its collection of robes of Royal Princes, carpets, an armory of old weapons, miniature paintings portraying court scenes, battle scenes and processions. **Also visit Jantar Mantar (observatory)** – which is the largest stone and marble crafted observatory in the world. Situated near

the gate of the City Palace, the observatory has 17 curiously shaped instruments, many of them still in working condition

Also experience a ride on the traditional Cycle Rickshaw. Enjoy a ride through the bustling city area of Jaipur.

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 13	Drive Jaipur-Ranthambhore 180 kms/4 hrs
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Breakfast at hotel

Check Out & drive to Ranthambhor

Situated in Eastern Rajasthan, the Ranthambhore National Park was once the hunting preserve of the Maharajas of Jaipur. The rivers Chambal in the South and Banas in the North bound the National Park. For the wildlife savvy, Ranthambhore wildlife sanctuary today offers an intense diversity of flora and fauna. Tigers, the park's pride make it one of the best places in the country to observe them. Apart from that a large numbers of Sambhar, Chital, Nilgai, Gazzelle, Boars, Mongoose, Indian Hare, Monitor Lizards and a large number of birds.



Upon arrival, check-in at hotel

Afternoon depart for Morning game drive by canter shared along with English speaking naturalist

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 14	Train to Bharatpur & drive to Agra by morning train / 90 minute drive
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Early breakfast at hotel

Check Out & transfer to Sawai Madhopur railway station to connect train for Agra

Departure Sawai Madhopur : 0710 hrs

Arrive Bharatpur : 0915 hrs

Meeting & assistance on arrival and transfer to Agra

En route visiting Fatehpursikri - The deserted red sandstone city that was built by Emperor Akbar as his capital. It was a veritable fairy tale city and its 'ruins are still in a pristine condition. It is not hard to imagine what the court life must have been like in the days of its grandeur.



After visit, continue trip to Agra

Agra: became the capital of Sikandar Lodi in 1501, but was soon passed on to the Mughals, both Babur and Humayun's made some early Mughal constructions here. It was under Akbar that Agra first aspired to its heights of magnificence from 1570-85 he ruled from nearby Fatehpur Sikri, when he abandoned that city he moved to Lahore (now in Pakistan) but returned to Agra in 1599, all later Mughal rulers ruled from Agra till 1761 it fell to the Jats who did much damage to the city.

On arrival, check-in at hotel

Agra fort - built alongside the Yamuna River stretching almost 2.5 km. The fort's colossal double walls rise 20 m in height and measure 2.5 km in circumference. The fort is surrounded by a moat. ***During the visit, we shall arrange a short transfer on Horse carriage "Tongas"***

Evening view Taj Mahal from across the banks of river Yamuna during sunset

Return to hotel for Dinner and Overnight

Day 15	Drive Agra-Delhi 200 kms/4 hrs drive	Wash & Change only
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Breakfast at hotel

Morning proceed to visit the Taj Mahal

"Taj Mahal – The symbol of love" (1631-1653), - a poem in white marble, built by Shah Jahan in memory of his beloved wife, Mumtaz Mahal. Rabindranath Tagore calls "a teardrop on the cheek of time". Taj Mahal means "Crown Palace" and is in fact the most well-preserved and architecturally beautiful tomb in the world. It is best described by the English poet, Sir Edwin Arnold, as "Not a piece of architecture, as other buildings are, but the proud passions of an emperor's love wrought in living stones."



(Please note that Taj Mahal is closed on every Friday)

After the visit, drive back to Delhi

On arrival, directly transfer to hotel (closer to airport)

Wash&change rooms for 2-3hrs use followed by Dinner

Later in the evening, drive to Indira Gandhi International airport to connect flight for onward destination

Day 16

**FLY OUT FROM DELHI
by international flight**

Fly with good memories of India trip... 😊😊

TOUR ENDS

Check In at all hotels is at 1400 hrs // Check Out time is 1200 hrs at noon